GRAVID- AMEN

What if the best nutrition advice for a pregnant mother in rural Limpopo was already in her pocket?

Overview

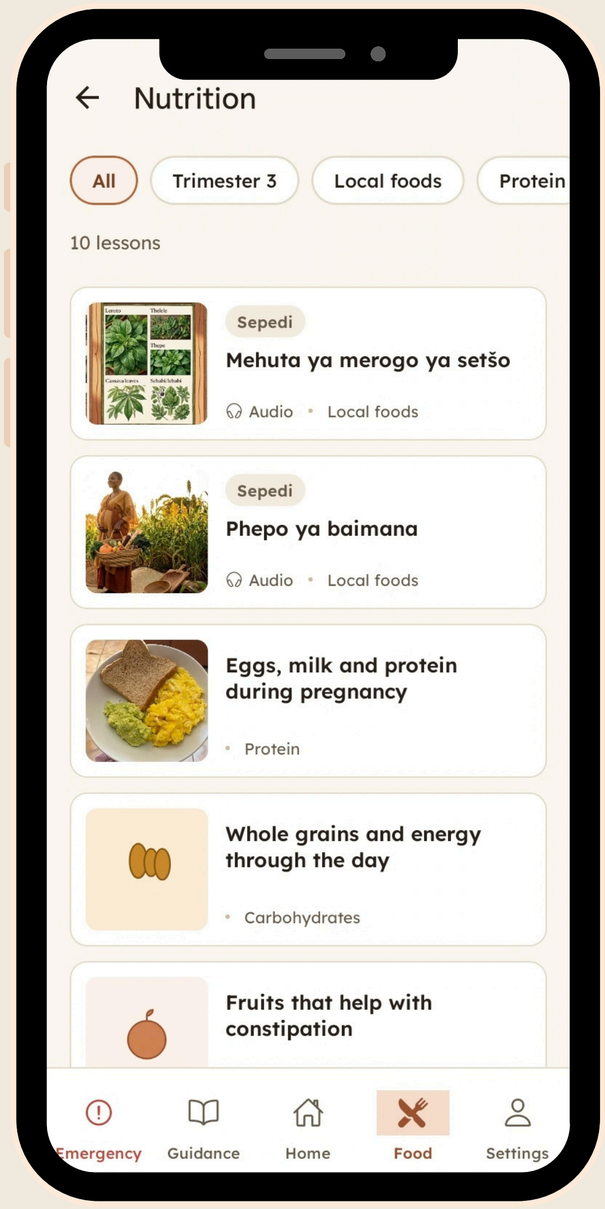
Pregnant women in rural Limpopo face high data costs, poor coverage, and a lack of nutrition guidance in Sepedi. Working with the University of Limpopo AMEN team, we built an offline app for these conditions and tested it against TikTok and YouTube through field tasks and co-design workshops. Finally, we handed over the codebase and findings for a wider pilot, backed by actionable design recommendations.

Objectives

A. Build a pilot-ready offline app

B. Test it against TikTok, YouTube

C. Hand it over to keep it going



What we built

Mobile app

works offline, resumes downloads, password-free profiles, Sepedi and English

+

Content dashboard

partner edits and adds lessons, no developer needed

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GitHub Actions

monitors package deprecation

How we tested it

51 participants 3 rural clinics 34 phones installed on

21 community health workers | 16 family decision-makers | 14 pregnant women

Part A: Try each channel

- Attempt five everyday tasks, e.g. finding a supper recipe
- Complete a 10-question rating scale
- Answer open-ended questions about what helped and what needed improving

Part B: Co-design with cards

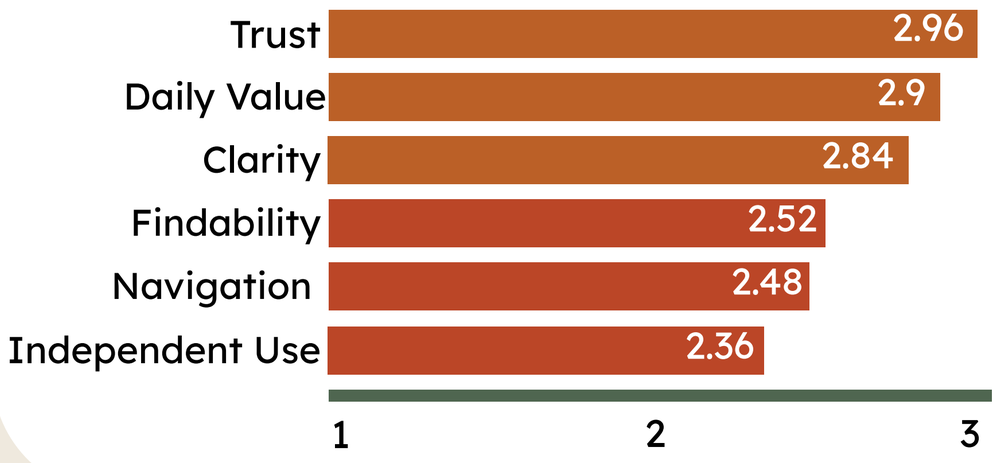
- Rank the three channels
- Rank three layouts: folders, search and a swipe feed
- Sort feature cards into “app”, “social media” or “both”
- Map how pregnancy information flows in the community



What we found

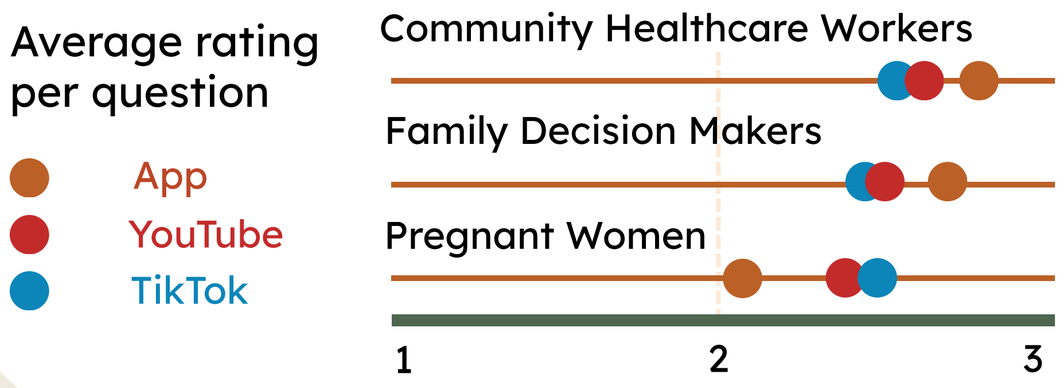
App was trusted, but hard to use alone

Weighted average of particpants. (1=disagree, 3=agree)



“The app is able to help me even when I don’t have data” - Pregnant Woman

Platform preference varied by group



Pregnant women preferred the app the least out of the groups

Conclusion

No single channel fits everyone. The app provides a trusted, data-free source, while social media drives reach. Cards and buttons must look tappable, and icons require local input for proper recognition. An app only lasts when access and warnings remain with someone who can act on them.

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